9.1.3 Configuration

At this point in the book, I've written *settings.py* 39 times. Django is very configurable, and all that happens in your settings.py file (40). If you're trying to understand how your system is configured, it can be useful to see the difference between your current settings and the defaults. The `diffsettings` management command does just that:

```
(venv) RiffMates$ python manage.py diffsettings
DEBUG = True
DEFAULT_AUTO_FIELD = 'django.db.models.BigAutoField'
EMAIL_BACKEND = 'django.core.mail.backends.console.EmailBackend'
INSTALLED_APPS = ['django.contrib.admin', 'django.contrib.auth',
    'django.contrib.contenttypes', 'django.contrib.sessions',
    'django.contrib.messages', 'django.contrib.staticfiles', 'home',
    'bands', 'content']
LOGIN_REDIRECT_URL = '/'
LOGOUT_REDIRECT_URL = '/'
ROOT_URLCONF = 'RiffMates.urls'  ###
```

This output is truncated; the full list can be quite long. In chapter 6 you added `LOGIN_REDIRECT_URL`, `LOGOUT_REDIRECT_URL`, and `EMAIL_BACKEND` to settings.py, so it might not be a surprise to see them. A little less obvious is `DEFAULT_AUTO_FIELD`. Although you haven't set it yourself, the skeleton settings.py file created by the `createproject` command sets this value. It shows up in the output because it is different from the default, even if that difference got created by Django.

Likewise, for the `INSTALLED_APPS` value; it shows here that you've added your own apps, but even if you hadn't, the various `django` apps included by `createproject` aren't in the underlying default configuration. This is where `diffsettings` can get a little noisy, even things you haven't changed yourself might not match the base configuration. This means you have to go wading through some values set by `createproject` to see what you actually changed.

Note the `###` on the end of the `ROOT_URLCONF` value; this is how `diffsettings` indicates a value that has no default. Your project won't work without a `ROOT_URLCONF`, but there is no default. Any custom values you add yourself will also appear with the `###` suffix. If you'd like to see all the default configuration values, the global_settings.py file in the Django source code is the place to look: http://mng.bz/yZn7.

9.1.4 Flushing the database

One of the many wonderful experiences in writing a book is learning something new yourself. Until playing around with a few management commands to write this chapter, I wasn't aware that `flush` even existed. This command wipes your database, except without resetting your migrations. Obviously, this is a drastic move, but when you're developing a new project that hasn't gone into production yet, you likely have a bunch of sample data kicking around from your manual testing. Using the `flush` command clears all database tables, keeping the structure and migration state. As you might hope, it asks if you're sure: